

Weekly Self-Study Tasks to Complete

Phase 1 — Week 4: CSS Fundamentals for Leaders

This document covers all of Week 4 in the 4-hour Leaders model: 2 hours of instructor-led session, 1 hour of self-study video, and 1 hour of hands-on lab. The Core Resources table below fits inside the 1-hour self-study media budget. The Practice Activities section points to the Evergreen Insurance Quote Page lab, where you will refactor the stylesheet to use CSS variables and rebrand the entire page with one change. Additional Content at the end is optional and sits outside the 4-hour budget.

Core Resources (~58 min)

Watch the specific clips called out below — not the entire course. Every link and duration in this table has been verified against the source platform. Keep Chrome DevTools open as you watch: the videos reference the Styles panel and box model diagram you saw in the instructor session.

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
CSS Big Picture	HTML, CSS, and JavaScript: The Big Picture (Barry Luijbregts, Pluralsight, updated Jul 2, 2025) — watch Module 4: Styling the Web with CSS (22 min). Explains what CSS is, why it exists, and how it fits with HTML and JavaScript. Pure concepts; no hands-on required. This is the same course used in Week 3 — if you finished it then, just this one module is new.	~22 min	pluralsight.com — HTML, CSS, and JS: The Big Picture
Box Model + Typography	CSS Essential Training (Christina Truong, LinkedIn Learning, released Aug 9, 2023) — watch a tight slice across two chapters.	~36 min	linkedin.com/learning — CSS Essential Training (Ch. 3 + 6)

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
	From Chapter 3 (The CSS Box Model): "Intro to the CSS box model" (0:58), "The box model properties" (3:44), "Box-sizing and the box model fix" (4:23), "Inline, block, and display" (4:39), "Debugging with developer tools" (5:06). From Chapter 6 (Typography): "Typography for the web" (3:11), "Changing fonts with font-family" (2:59), "The font-size property" (4:06), "Text-align and text-transform" (3:26). Reinforces the instructor demo and prepares you for the lab.		

Practice Activities (1 hour)

Complete this week's hands-on lab: "Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — Brand Refresh with CSS Variables." You will audit the stylesheet for duplicated brand colors, introduce CSS variables at :root, migrate every hardcoded color to a var(--...) reference, and then change one variable value to rebrand the entire page from Evergreen green to Liberty Mutual blue. Along the way you will use Chrome DevTools to read and tweak the box model. The whole exercise takes about one hour.

In the lab you will:

- Open the Labfiles/evergreen-quote-brand-refresh folder in VS Code from the command line.
- Run the app with the Live Server extension and open Chrome DevTools.
- Use VS Code Find to count duplication of the brand green (#0f5132) across styles.css.
- Add a :root block that declares the brand palette and form padding as CSS variables.

- Replace every hardcoded color in styles.css with the matching var(--name) reference — the page should stay visually identical.
- Change --primary from Evergreen green to Liberty Mutual blue (#0066b2) and watch the header, hero heading, buttons, and premium box rebrand in one save.
- Inspect the .quote-form-section box model in Chrome DevTools, experiment with padding values, then bump --form-padding from 24px to 32px to make the change permanent.
- Review the full change in VS Code's Source Control panel and with git diff --stat in the integrated terminal.
- Commit the change ("Refactor styles to use CSS variables; rebrand to LM blue").

The lab instructions (with "Why this matters" callouts throughout) are in the lab environment. Budget one hour and work at your own pace.

Additional Content (Optional)

The following resources are optional and recommended for students who want to go deeper beyond the core curriculum. They are outside the 4-hour weekly budget. Flexbox and CSS Grid are covered in a dedicated later module (Week 5), so focus this week on selectors, the box model, and CSS variables.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
CSS	CSS Essential Training (Christina Truong, LinkedIn Learning, Aug 2023) — complete course (5h 27m) covering selectors, layouts, Flexbox and Grid, responsive design, advanced selectors, and a final project (Video Course)	linkedin.com/learning — full course
CSS	Learning Web Design, 6th Edition — Jennifer Niederst Robbins (O'Reilly, Jul 2025). Parts III and IV are a complete walk-through of CSS from selectors to modern layout. Same book referenced in Week 3; Week 4 draws from later chapters (Book)	oreilly.com — Learning Web Design, 6th Ed.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
CSS	Learn CSS — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Free, authoritative path covering CSS first steps, building blocks, text styling, layout, and responsive design (Reference / Tutorial)	developer.mozilla.org — Learn CSS
CSS Variables	Using CSS custom properties (variables) — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Deeper dive into this week's lab topic: declarations, scope, inheritance, and fallbacks (Reference)	developer.mozilla.org — CSS custom properties
Box Model	The box model — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Step-by-step explanation of content, padding, border, and margin with interactive examples and the box-sizing fix (Tutorial)	developer.mozilla.org — The box model
Responsive Design	Responsive design — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Media queries, viewport meta, fluid layouts, and responsive images (Tutorial)	developer.mozilla.org — Responsive design
CSS Reference	CSS-Tricks (Chris Coyier and DigitalOcean) — Almanac, snippets, and working-engineer guides. Pragmatic reference for any CSS property leaders hear in a code review (Reference)	css-tricks.com
Browser Support	Can I Use — up-to-the-day browser-support matrix for every CSS feature. Useful when you hear an engineer ask “is it safe to ship?” (Tool)	caniuse.com